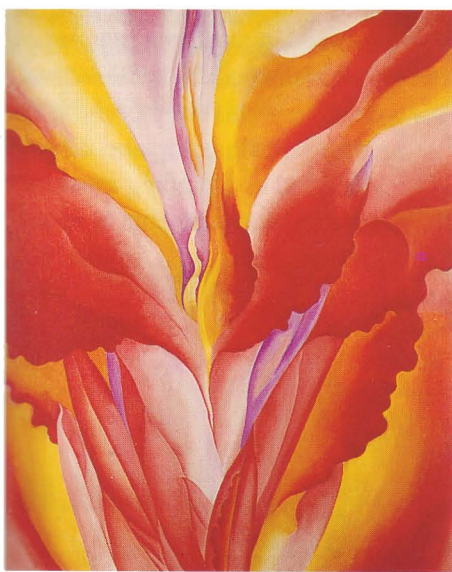




Paul Cézanne, *Green Apples*,

c.1873 10¼ x 12¼ in (26 x 32 cm)

Cézanne's work differs from that of the Impressionists in its adherence to formal traditions of painting. He was unique in his use of color and analytical approach to shapes. The warm orange-brown ground here contrasts with the cool, striking green apples.



Georgia O'Keeffe, *Red Canna*,

c.1923 36 x 29½ in (91 x 76 cm)

This is very different from the cool poise of Ruysch's work – O'Keeffe's flower is suffused with hot color and is alive with feeling. The adjacent colors are simply blended, but together they form a stunning image.

Gerhard Richter, *Betty*,

1988 40¼ x 28½ in (102 x 72 cm)

This portrait has a forceful power and intensity. The immaculate but engaging nature of the painted surface turns this image into something precious. In a world of millions of snapshots, Richter painstakingly retrieves one of them and asks us to look at it again carefully.



Twentieth-century style

With oil paint now used and adapted for a diversity of painting styles, its position at the forefront of painting media has been reinforced in the twentieth century. The German artist Gerhard Richter (b. 1932) has considered the relationship between painting and photography. His 1960s monochromatic paintings, based on newspaper photographs, exploited the way oil color could be blended. He found a correlation between oil techniques and the smooth, often blurred quality of photographs.

During the most recent decades, many artists have found distinctive ways of working with this painting medium to give us new insights and meanings. Works by the Italian artists Francesco Clemente (b. 1952), Enzo Cucchi (b. 1949), and Mimmo Paladino (b. 1948), although personal and individualistic, give expression to universal needs and aspirations. The cool, powerful works of British artist Lucien Freud (b. 1922) demonstrate the impact and intensity that can

be achieved by painting directly from life, while the less direct approach of Howard Hodgkin (b. 1932) to his subjects has resulted in forceful works controlled by strong, energetic color. Paintings by artists such as Christopher Lebrun (b. 1951) appear to draw on myths and images from the past, but they remain utterly contemporary in their engagement with surface, texture, and color. In the US and elsewhere in the world, a number of artists have begun to find inspiration in new forms of abstraction that still draw on the same techniques and traditions used for over five hundred years.